

Cover Letter

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Hiring Manager
Stripe

Dear Hiring Manager,

I am excited to apply for the Technical Leader position on Stripe's Data Platform team, where my extensive experience in architecting scalable, data-intensive systems and leading cross-functional initiatives aligns perfectly with your mission to increase the GDP of the internet. With a Master's in Computer Science from TTU and over 20 years of engineering expertise, I am eager to drive Stripe's critical data infrastructure projects, ensuring security, reliability, and performance while mentoring teams to foster technical excellence.

In my current role as Director of Cloud Architecture at Biophy, I led the design and implementation of an AI-powered Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) platform, architecting a scalable, event-driven data pipeline using Python, FastAPI, Apache Kafka, and AWS (EKS, S3, Lambda). By optimizing PostgreSQL and Elasticsearch with Terraform-defined infrastructure, I reduced processing latency by 50% and scaled the system to handle millions of data points daily. At McKinsey & Company, I spearheaded a company-wide initiative to migrate legacy mainframe systems to a cloud-native architecture using Databricks, Spark, and AWS serverless technologies, collaborating with data scientists, product engineers, and leadership to deliver a genAI platform with measurable business impact. These experiences demonstrate my ability to lead large-scale, cross-cutting efforts akin to Stripe's Data Platform initiatives.

My expertise in distributed systems and modern data technologies positions me to excel at Stripe. At Yotascale, I architected a cross-cloud analytics platform using Kubernetes and PostgreSQL, ensuring reliability and scalability for microservices. My hands-on work with Kafka, Spark, and CI/CD pipelines at Comcast and Biophy aligns with Stripe's tech stack, including Airflow, Presto, and Iceberg. I have a proven track record of collaborating across teams, as seen in my leadership of a 30-member working group at Barclays to define distributed systems strategies, and my ability to present clear, opinionated analyses to senior stakeholders at McKinsey, enabling informed decision-making with well-defined tradeoffs.

As a mentor, I have consistently invested in team growth, guiding engineers on Clean Architecture and AWS best practices at Biophy and leading workshops on genAI at McKinsey. My user-centric approach, demonstrated by building

reusable tools like an open-source JSON resume framework, aligns with Stripe's focus on clean, productized interfaces for engineers. I thrive in navigating complex technical and organizational challenges, delivering secure, efficient solutions with minimal oversight, and fostering a culture of technical curiosity and excellence.

I am inspired by Stripe's commitment to empowering businesses through robust data infrastructure and am eager to contribute my technical leadership, domain expertise in data platforms and AI, and passion for impactful solutions to drive your mission forward. Thank you for considering my application. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my skills can support Stripe's goals. Please feel free to contact me at 856-408-4027 or rongyj@hotmail.com to schedule a conversation.

Sincerely,
Yongjun Rong